

A

Elections in the UK

When you **vote for** someone, you choose them by putting a cross (X) on an official piece of paper (called a **secret ballot** because no one knows who you vote for), or by putting up your hand. In the UK, a **general election** is when the people **elect**¹ the next **government**². These **elections** are **held**³ at least every five years. Each **constituency**⁴ elects one person from one **political party**. That person then becomes the **MP** (Member of Parliament) for that area, and the political party with the most MPs – there are 650 at the moment – forms the next government. The **leader**⁵ of the party **in power**⁶ is the **Prime Minister**.

¹ choose by voting

² the group of people who control the country

³ organised

⁴ an area where people vote

⁵ the person in control

⁶ in control (of the country)

Language help

noun	person	adjective
politics	politician	political
power		powerful

B

Political policies

People usually vote for a political party because they **believe in** the party's ideas [think the ideas are good or right], and these ideas become **policies** [sets of plans and ideas that a political party has agreed on].



VOTE FOR US AND WE WILL ...

-  **provide**¹ free nursery education **for** all children
-  provide more **care**² and **support**³ for **elderly**⁴ people
-  **reduce**⁵ unemployment
-  create a **fair**⁶ **tax**⁷ system





Above all⁸, we will **treat**⁹ people as **equal**¹⁰.

¹ give something to those who need it (also **provide** someone **with** something)

² looking after people, especially old people

³ help (sometimes in the form of money)

⁴ old

⁵ make less; *syn* **cut**

⁶ dealing with everyone in the same way; *opp* **unfair**

⁷ money people must pay the government

⁸ most importantly

⁹ behave or deal with someone in a particular way

¹⁰ having the same importance; *adv* **equally**

Language help

verb	noun
believe in sth	belief
reduce	reduction